GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

September 12th, 2025
Week 37
Volume 276, Issue 1202

Highlights:

- **Concerning.**
- **Conflicts conflate.**
- **HKC aims.**
- **Depreciation.**
- **Freight rules.**
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QUOTE of the WEEK

"One man with courage makes a majority."

– Andrew Jackson

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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GOVERNING GOOF-UPS!

As global conflicts rage on with no signs of resolution or abatement on the horizon, the ongoing and deliberate spectacle of political goof-ups continues to dictate the destiny of global freight rates as well as the ship recycling markets — with determined impunity. Escalatory and retaliatory moves kept key trading routes and markets on edge as freight rates propped up this week, with the Baltic Exchange Dry Index reporting a whopping 7.4% overall increase. Capesize, Panamax, and Supramax indices all firmed in unison to the tune of 1.0%, 0.4%, and 0.5% respectively. As trading rates jumped, so did crude oil—albeit marginally—ending the week at USD 62.74/barrel (vs. USD 62.14/barrel at the start of the week).

Mixed in with the craziness of tariffs is the growing and murky collection of sanctioned units that continue to trickle into the markets along with legitimate ones. This week also delivered an early Christmas surprise as tonnage that had been missing from the bidding tables for weeks on end somehow managed to find its way onto Indian sub-continent recycling beaches—marginally in Bangladesh and en masse into India, with over 155K Tons LDT and a few behemoth LNGs arriving at both waterfronts. Certainly an "ice-cube down the back" kind of flashback moment to the glorious days of loaded recycling beaches.

As we segue into individual sub-continent ship recycling destinations, with yard infrastructure upgrades ticking forward by the week, HKC approvals remain the bright spot in Bangladesh as 18 ship recycling yards are now fully accredited to global standards. Pakistan remains far behind, with only news of upgrades coming forth, but the coveted "first yard in Pakistan to get HKC certified" title remains missing a participants list htus far. Currencies also nailed down the week's pressure points—especially in India—as virtually all recycling nation currencies depreciated in the teens against the U.S. Dollar. Surprisingly, it wasn't Turkey that took the largest currency hit of the week, even though there is one to report from here too. Steel plate prices, by contrast, flatlined across the spectrum—even in China—as fresh tariff rumors made the rounds once again.

Overall, as the stasis of inactivity evaporated in Alang this week, India remained whipsawed by the INR's ongoing collapse, and protectionist-minded headwinds from local buyers will likely greet sellers with tumbling demand and pricing in response. Bangladesh remains inert overall, as its interim regime fails to revive activity and beachings are like drops of rain in the desert. Pakistan stays eager but forcibly idle, unable to secure vessels while freight trades rich and local buyers remain unwilling to discard their precious DASRs on small LDT units. Turkey remains in the cellar, red tape intact, and activity nil.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 37 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

Bleak and weak!

Dire.

The bleak situation in Bangladesh that started festering back in June 2024, has further metastasized into madness over the last 2–3 months and it seems unlikely to improve any time soon, as the local mindset continues to devolve week after week amid inglorious inactivity. The inert interim regime has failed to fire up any meaningful infrastructure projects, leaving local steel mills sourcing cheaper steel from imported sources and further darkening Chattogram's future as a ship recycling destination—at least until the next elections that are currently set six months away in February 2026. Recently imposed HKC requirements have further burdened the otherwise industry-leading performance of this market, as local recyclers stagger through their HKC approvals at differing speeds, which explains the trickle of tonnage we have seen drip into this market since June 26, 2025.

Port empty.

And as the last couple of weeks saw no fresh units arrive or even local deliveries, this week surprised the industry as at least one top-tier local buyer jumped at the opportunity of snagging a passing behemoth as the only arrival of the week saw a near 30K LDT LNG carrier greet Chattogram's inner anchorage. However, the prior empty weeks of vessel reports highlight a deeper malaise: a complete lack of demand or even interest to negotiate on, let alone import new vessels locally. Inventories of recycled ship steel at recycling plots also continues to pile up as recyclers remain unable to shift any of it at prices anywhere near what their vessels were concluded at.

Propping up.

As a result (and if history has taught the industry about Bangladesh), it is likely that local steel plate prices are flatlining as recyclers attempt to withhold raw material and artificially induce demand from local steel mills by holding prices firm. Although this can help in the short term, markets always correct themselves, and the resulting renegotiations that left Bangladesh souring at the bottom end of market rankings in the past, will almost certainly redeliver once again. And this does appear to be the case now as well since steel values remained stuck at BDT 519.59/Ton throughout the week and tariff pressures nudged the Bangladeshi Taka higher by about 18 basis points, ending the week at BDT 122.02 against the U.S. Dollar.

Fresh fruit.

On the domestic front, however, despite an inert administration, HKC squabbles, deteriorating fundamentals, and impending tariffs creating rumbling tummies, the nation's economy managed to find some impressive resilience as inflation fell from a high of 8.55% back in July to 8.28% as August closed, the lowest inflation the nation has endured since July 2022. And clearly not intentional on the part of this or prior administrations. Yet local recyclers remain unable to get the gears of recycling turning enough to attract even those vessels positioned in the Far East or even smaller LDT units as most are being diverted to higher markets in Pakistan and India, while in Bangladesh, as in Pakistan with their provisional DASRs, Bangladesh's HKC approvals for yards and for intended incoming vessels remains a fruit too fresh for local buyers to overeagerly pluck at this juncture.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

BIG…WHILE BUSTED!

The big news from India came via the port of Alang this week, as local recyclers cautiously celebrated an anchorage holding over 155K tons of recycling tonnage either at anchor or delivered locally. Minus the prior long-term campers, Alang recyclers not only greeted a 10K and 14K LDT tanker, but, far more impressively, two massive 33K LDT LNG carriers that brought in the big waves—and some much-needed excitement that was immediately been busted by the elephants of tariffs and a subsequently weakening Indian Rupee.

Cautious.

With the INR now trading at an unprecedented historical low in the high Rs. 88s against the U.S. Dollar over the last couple of weeks, a noticeable degree of caution and reticence has entered the local playbook, leaving end buyers surveying the financial terrain for potential currency moves before offering afresh once again.As reported in the market commentary above, India's perennially volatile steel plate prices that have always prone to roller-coaster swings—witnessing two weeks of flatlining within the span of month certainly is a watershed moment for the nation's economy. As plate prices levelled off at USD 448/Ton, the Rupee took over the reins sliding 11 basis points across the week to end deeper at INR 88.28 against the U.S. Dollar.

Steel slide.

As a result, the wild ride of the Rupee remains the chief talking point for Alang recyclers as the currency has suffered an over 5% depreciation in the last 12 months alone, continually dragging down prices, demand and sentiments in the wake of aggressive Trump tariffs and sanctions against India.

The macro picture does seem rosier in comparison as on the one hand, even though inflation accelerated from 1.6% in July to 2.1% in August, CPI remains very much in the healthy range and should be able to weather incoming storms. India's fiscal deficit is also expected to reduce, while GDP is projected to climb to nearly 7% (as forecasted by Fitch). Yet these long-term potentials don't feed current-day needs, and while LNGs have become a surprising driver of large LDT, non-ferrous-rich behemoths into Alang over recent months, with a growing number of sanctioned vessels expected to join recycling ranks before year-end, a nervy Indian market may see certain vessels diverted to competing Pakistan once again – especially if the Rupee continues to slip and Trumps bloated 50% sanctions do hit home.

Sanction woes.

Hard times for recycling in Alang, HKC or otherwise.

Hard times.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

DATE WITH DESTINY!

Disappointed.

As the highest-placed Indian sub-continent ship recycling destination for probably over two months now, Pakistani ship recyclers will be disappointed not to get their hands on any of the decent LDT tonnage that was recently committed to competing India and even the far lower-placed Bangladeshi market. DASR certificates are being issued (as evident from the handful of recent deliveries), and HKC yard upgrades are also reportedly ongoing. Yet it would be useful for Gadani buyers to test the new HKC regulations with a greater supply of vessels, rather than relying on the strained and conditional approvals currently being granted by the government to this vital industry via provisional DASRs.

HKC awaits.

Making matters worse, with the Pakistan market not being as competitive for non-ferrous recovery from recycled vessels—not to mention the fact that LNGs carrying perlite are banned from entering Pakistan altogether—the festering silence of the Gadani Gang at the bidding tables of late has delivered the inevitable outcome of an empty port report for the second week in a row.

Certainly not a good sign for a market where although seeing its own Rupee depreciate the most in the industry this week (by nearly 19 basis points and end it at nearly PKR 284 against the U.S. Dollar), has been blind to the unparalleled flatlined performance of local steel plate prices, which remain at or above USD 625/Ton. To put this in context: India's plate prices are at USD 448/Ton, and Bangladesh's are at USD 519/Ton. Even a generous grant of import tax relief, duties, and fees could not bridge a gap of over USD 100/Ton on the value of a ship—let alone one that's approaching nearly USD 200/Ton.

Awaiting backlog.

While this may explain the ability of local recyclers to survive the mean and lean times, in truly bad times it bites even harder—and unnecessarily so. Of course, as the HKC / DASR / limited-supply love triangle plays out on the beaches of Gadani, 2025 has still managed to deliver sporadic phases of healthy deliveries in both Bangladesh and India. But not in Pakistan. So what does the future of recycling hold for this market? While the government has reportedly set up grants to ensure Gadani's continuity with ship recycling, how local recyclers commandeer this ship through 2025's headwinds remains to be seen.

Destiny awaits.

For now, it's a tough time for the locals, and if you're an owner with a big unit and are okay with "pale green" recycling, this is your market. As comedians say, "Destiny awaits, let's just hope she's pretty".

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

LIKE THE GANG!

Just like the rest of the industry, the Turkish Lira ended the week 18 basis points weaker at TRY 41.33 against the U.S. Dollar, all while a highly anticipated price cut in vessels prices remained safely amiss.

Price cut?

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 37 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
2	India	**Steady**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *Ghostly Halos on the Seafloor — Barrels dumped off Southern California decades ago have been leaking alkaline waste (not just DDT), creating eerie white "halos" and altering seafloor ecosystems in unexpected ways.*
- *Lost Byzantine City Tharais, Jordan — Archaeologists uncovered the remains of the lost city of Tharais, including a church, mosaics, and a basilica-style structure that signals a Christian settlement hidden for centuries.*
- *Underground Muon Imaging at Ancient Jerusalem — Scientists used cosmic-ray muon detection methods to map hidden voids beneath ancient sites in Jerusalem (Jeremiah's Cistern). The anomalies suggest structural features not yet fully explained.*
- *Mysterious Sundial at Aigai (Turkey) — A remarkably preserved 2,200-year-old sundial was unearthed, revealing mysterious markings and mechanisms whose full function still isn't clear.*
- *Wizard-Doctor Tomb in Egypt — The tomb of a high-status healer/priest ("wizard doctor") from Egypt's 5th Dynasty was found with rare medical instruments, raising questions about the extent of ancient medical-spiritual knowledge.*
- *Boat Burial with Dog in Norway — On Senja Island, a Viking-era ship burial was found (c. AD 900-950), which included a woman and a small dog. Who they were, and what their status was, adds a haunting human layer to the find.*
- *Avar-Era Cemetery in Hungary — Discovered via aerial surveys, two log-coffin tombs among rectilinear discolorations in a grain field suggest ritual or burials with unknown rites.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No major holidays in September	September 05 - September 14 September 19 – September 27

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
September 05 – Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	September 07 – September 10 September 20 – September 23

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
September 05 – Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	**No major holidays in September**

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ALANG - Port Position as of September 12, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Coal II	14,840	Oil Tanker	Arrived September 13
2	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
3	*FP Future*	*9,799*	*Woodchip Carrier*	*Delivered September 11*
4	*Khaza*	*33,456*	*LNG Carrier*	*Delivered September 09*
5	*Mahar*	*18,264*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered September 06*
6	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
7	Pione	10,129	Oil Tanker	Arrived September 12
8	Rising Falcon	5,964	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 12
9	*Shaan*	*33,406*	*LNG Carrier*	*Delivered September 10*
Total Tonnage		**155,482**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of September 12, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	DK 03	7,809	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 04
2	Rade	29,941	LNG Carrier	Arrived September 12
		37,750		

GADANI - Port Position as of September 12, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
		No vessels reported.		
Total Tonnage		**-**		

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/6/2025	448.88	38,000.00	625.44	177,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/7/2025	448.88	38,000.00	625.44	177,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/8/2025	448.88	38,200.00	625.44	177,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/9/2025	448.88	38,300.00	625.44	177,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/10/2025	448.88	38,300.00	625.44	177,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/11/2025	448.88	38,100.00	625.44	177,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17
9/12/2025	448.88	37,900.00	625.44	177,000.00	519.59	63,000.00	310.17

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